WORKING PAPER · DRAFT FOR DISCUSSION

# The Golden Third

A static costing and distributional model of a shared tax and social-protection framework for a group of European states

**Initiative 28:28**

Model version v4.60 · 1 November 2026 · Licence CC BY 4.0 · Research kit and figures to cite: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23855733 · Website: archicrowd.github.io/goldenes-drittel/ · Contact: tax.better@archicrowd.de

## Abstract

We describe a proposal under which a group of states adopts common rules for income taxation and social protection, and we document a transparent, static model of its costs and distributional effects. Income of every kind is taxed in steps of 0, 11, 19, 25 and 33 per cent tied to each country's basic need; social contributions are abolished and employers must pass at least 80 per cent of the employer contributions that disappear into wages; a tax-financed safety net covers health care, long-term care and basic needs; every adult receives a monthly transformation dividend; 10 per cent of gross wages go into a personal, locked pension account; and public debt and unfunded pension promises are moved into a common fund repaid by 2098. For 2028, in purchasing power of 2026, a single employee at the average wage gains between 276 € and 726 € per month in Germany, France, Italy and Spain and 1,404 zł in Poland. The Gini coefficient falls in all five countries, by 6.2 points at most. The common fund requires 5.17 per cent of GDP a year, a surcharge of 15.5 per cent on all taxes at an interest rate of 2.45 per cent, and peaks at 148.1 per cent of GDP in 2055. Losers are German pensioner households (only 32.2 per cent better off), single earners in France at half the average wage, and one-earner couples at twice the average wage. The model has no behavioural responses; the main uncertainties are the pass-through of employer contributions, the fund interest rate and the tax base of company profits taxed where customers are.

**Keywords:** tax reform, social protection, basic income, transformation dividend, payroll tax incidence, public debt, Europe. **JEL:** H20, H24, H55, H63, I38.

## 1 Introduction

Most European states finance social protection to a large extent through contributions levied on wages, combine them with progressive income taxes and an array of means-tested benefits, and carry public debt and unfunded pension promises from the past. The resulting systems are complex, and the marginal burden on additional earnings is high in parts of the income distribution. The proposal examined here – named *The Golden Third* after its upper tax rate of one third – replaces this structure with a small number of common rules that a group of states could adopt jointly.

This paper does not derive an optimal tax system. It is a costing and distributional accounting exercise: given the rules, what does the system cost, who gains and who loses compared with the law of 2026, and how sensitive are these results to the main assumptions? All figures come from one calculation chain of 70 stages based on official statistics. Every change to the model is recorded in a log, and every error found is numbered as a correction (83 so far). The chain was recalculated in three reviews commissioned by the initiative; the last review covered model version v4.42 (section 8).

Section 2 describes the rules, section 3 the model and data, section 4 the results for households, distribution and public finances, section 5 the sensitivity to key assumptions, and section 6 the behavioural evidence that the static model does not capture. Section 7 lists limitations and open questions; section 8 the review history.

## 2 The proposal

| | |
|---|---|
| **Income tax** | Rates 0 / 11 / 19 / 25 / 33 % in brackets defined as multiples of each country's basic need. Gross income without deductions; individual taxation (no splitting or family quotient). Capital income, profits and inheritance are taxed at most at 33 %; company profits are taxed where customers are, including digital platforms. |
| **Contributions** | Social contributions are abolished. Employers are legally obliged to pass at least 80 % of the employer contributions to social security that disappear into gross wages, up to six times basic need; a fallback rule applies if contracts are not adjusted by the start date. |
| **Strong net** | Health care, long-term care (partial), minimum pension, basic needs in disability and unemployment, financed from general taxes. A floor equal to basic need times an equivalence scale (0.5 for each further adult, 0.55 per child) is guaranteed; own earnings count by half. In Germany the floor is 1,029 € per month for a single person (2028, purchasing power 2026). Low earners are topped up on an application that the authority pre-fills. |
| **Dividend** | Monthly payment to every adult, 80 % for children, without application; financed from steering taxes (carbon and other) and from gains of digitalisation. It falls as emissions fall. |
| **Own route** | Compulsory saving of 10 % of gross wages into a personal account, locked until retirement age, with few investment options and a default fund. |
| **VAT label** | Rates 5 / 11 / 17 / 25 %, special rate 33 % only for harmful goods. Suppliers obtain lower rates through certification by supervised bodies. |
| **Legacy** | Public debt and unfunded pension promises above the dividend move into a common fund of the participating states, financed by a surcharge on all taxes. Existing pension promises above basic need are reduced by 15 %; own savings are not reduced (pension rule E). The effective reduction of pension payments differs by state, from 1.9 % to 12.1 % (6.95 % in Germany). |

## 3 Model and data

**Scope.** The calculations cover a possibility space of 30 European states with 465.6 million inhabitants and a GDP of 19,515 billion euro (2024). Ten states are calculated in detail; the common fund of 30 states is the decision of the ten scaled by the ratio 30/10 from the possibility space (assumption). Household results are computed for five reference countries: Germany, France, Italy, Spain and Poland.

**Revenue and expenditure.** Tax bases (wages, profits, consumption, wealth, inheritance) and current expenditure come from Eurostat national and government accounts (gov_10a_exp, gov_10a_taxag, nama_10_gdp); unfunded pension claims from the supplementary pension tables (nasa_10_pens1, table 29); debt from gov_10dd_edpt1. The tax base of company profits taxed where customers are is the largest position that is not yet documented against an independent source.

**Households today.** Each reference country has a simplified model of 2026 law: income tax, employee and employer contributions and cash benefits including minimum income schemes (Germany: Bürgergeld approximation with housing and child supplements; France: APL and prime d'activité; Italy: Assegno di Inclusione; Spain: Ingreso Mínimo Vital and child supplement; Poland: zasiłek okresowy). Parameters come partly from official sources and partly from secondary sources; the parameter files mark each block as official, secondary or assumption. The models were checked against the OECD tax wedge: 7 of 10 household types lie within ±2 percentage points (Table 3).

**Germany.** A synthetic microsimulation, calibrated to official totals, covers employees, civil servants, self-employed, minimum-income recipients and pensioners. Validation against 2025: gross wages −2.8 %, wage tax −5.4 %. Pensioner incomes come from EU-SILC 2025 and the German old-age income survey (ASID 2023), both as published aggregates. No micro data are used.

**Distribution.** The Gini coefficient for 2028 is the official value for 2025 (EU-SILC) plus the change computed on the published decile distribution. VAT burdens by income come from the German household budget survey (EVS 2023) and, for France, from Eurostat's Household Budget Survey 2020; Italy, Spain and Poland use a factor of 1 so far.

**Conventions.** Amounts for 2028 are in purchasing power of 2026. The model is static: labour supply, saving, prices beyond a one-off level effect and migration do not respond. Pass-through of employer contributions, take-up, avoidance and VAT incidence enter as parameters or bands. Take-up of the floor is assumed to be complete.

# 4 Results

## 4.1 Households in five countries

Table 1 shows the change in disposable income for three household types at half, once and twice the average wage. In Germany a single employee at the average wage gains +726 € per month; at a gross wage of € 42,000, about two thirds of the average wage, the gain is +611 € for a single person, +610 € for a single parent and +674 € for a one-earner couple with two children.

**Table 1: Change in monthly disposable income, 2028**

| Country | Household | ½ × AW | 1 × AW | 2 × AW | Better off |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Germany | single | +586 € | +726 € | +710 € | 98 % |
| | single parent, 1 child | +588 € | +721 € | +707 € | 98 % |
| | couple, one earner, 2 children | +561 € | +688 € | +78 € | 98 % |
| France | single | −148 € | +276 € | +459 € | 73 % |
| | single parent, 1 child | +205 € | +228 € | +253 € | 73 % |
| | couple, one earner, 2 children | +760 € | +380 € | 0 € | 98 % |
| Italy | single | +304 € | +412 € | +766 € | 100 % |
| | single parent, 1 child | +413 € | +416 € | +824 € | 100 % |
| | couple, one earner, 2 children | +1,054 € | +619 € | +1,021 € | 100 % |
| Spain | single | +217 € | +321 € | +336 € | 98 % |
| | single parent, 1 child | +477 € | +317 € | +401 € | 100 % |
| | couple, one earner, 2 children | +1,233 € | +662 € | +701 € | 100 % |
| Poland | single | +1,406 zł | +1,404 zł | +1,554 zł | 100 % |
| | single parent, 1 child | +1,971 zł | +909 zł | +338 zł | 98 % |
| | couple, one earner, 2 children | +4,029 zł | +2,246 zł | +722 zł | 98 % |

Change in monthly disposable income, 2028, purchasing power 2026; Poland in złoty. AW: average wage, OECD Taxing Wages 2024 (Germany 63,288 €; France 44,968 €; Italy 35,616 €; Spain 31,698 €; Poland 96,421 zł). Better off: share of employees of this household type across the wage distribution; the German wage distribution is scaled to each country's average wage (assumption). Each country carries its own legacy surcharge after netting in the common fund.

Three patterns stand out. First, one-earner couples with higher wages lose part of today's joint taxation (German splitting, French quotient familial), because every adult is taxed individually and receives an own dividend; around twice the average wage the gain is close to zero in Germany (+78 €) and France (0 €). Second, single earners in France at half the average wage lose 148 € per month: today's in-work benefit and family allowances are replaced by the dividend and the floor, and employer contributions near the minimum wage are already largely waived today, so little is passed on. Third, in Italy, Spain and Poland, where minimum income schemes reach fewer households today, the floor and the dividend raise low incomes more strongly.

**Table 2: Inequality and legacy surcharge**

| Country | Gini 2025 (official) | Gini 2028 (model) | Change | Legacy surcharge 2028 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Germany | 30.1 | 26.1 | −4.0 | 15.0 % |
| France | 30.4 | 29.0 | −1.4 | 21.3 % |
| Italy | 31.0 | 26.9 | −4.1 | 22.3 % |
| Spain | 30.8 | 25.0 | −5.8 | 18.3 % |
| Poland | 24.9 | 18.7 | −6.2 | 13.5 % |

Gini coefficient of equivalised disposable income (0–100). 2025: Eurostat ilc_di12 (EU-SILC 2025). 2028: official value plus the change computed in the model from the decile distribution (Eurostat ilc_di01); not a microsimulation except for Germany.

**Table 3: Validation of the country models against the OECD tax wedge**

| Country | Single: model | OECD | Diff. (pp) | Couple, 2 ch.: model | OECD | Diff. (pp) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Germany | 48.9 | 49.3 | −0.4 | 34.7 | 34.9 | −0.2 |
| France | 46.0 | 47.2 | −1.2 | 33.5 | 39.1 | −5.6 |
| Italy | 44.4 | 45.8 | −1.4 | 33.0 | 34.3 | −1.3 |
| Spain | 42.4 | 41.4 | +1.0 | 37.8 | 36.8 | +1.0 |
| Poland | 40.3 | 35.0 | +5.3 | 20.7 | 14.2 | +6.5 |

Tax wedge in % of labour costs at the average wage. Model: 2026 law; OECD: Taxing Wages 2026 (2025 data).

Poland: the OECD counts neither accident insurance nor the labour and guarantee funds on the employer side, and treats the health contribution differently (open). France, couple: the model pays the prime d'activité at this wage level, consistent with ministry examples for the 2026 reform; the OECD apparently does not (to be checked).

## 4.2 Germany: all households and pensioners

In the German microsimulation 85.1 % of working-age households and 69.3 % of all households are better off. By status of the main earner: full-time 99.1 %, part-time 99.9 %, self-employed 77.7 %, civil servants 56.4 %, mini-job 49.1 %, households without earnings 18.0 %. Under pension rule E, 32.2 % of pensioner households are better off; the mean change is −121 € per month, from +24 € in the lowest to −478 € in the highest fifth. Pensioners lose because their contributions to health and long-term care disappear while pension promises above basic need are reduced, and because the dividend does not fully replace these amounts in the upper part of the distribution.

## 4.3 Public finances

Table 4 shows the strong net and the dividend for Germany. The dividend amounts to 354 € per adult and 283 € per child and month in 2028 (Table 4 shows the dividend in per cent of GDP). Its share of GDP falls from 7.25 % in 2028 to 3.40 % in 2060 because steering revenue falls with emissions. The total burden of taxes and fund is 38.7 % of GDP in 2028 against 40.76 % today (Eurostat 2024); including compulsory saving, which goes to an own account, it is 42.8 %.

**Table 4: Strong net and dividend, Germany**

| Germany, % of GDP | 2028 | 2060 |
|---|---|---|
| Health care (basic coverage) | 7.36 | 7.63 |
| Long-term care (partial) | 0.85 | 1.41 |
| Minimum pension (67+) | 0.00 | 0.53 |
| Disability (basic need) | 0.30 | 0.30 |
| Unemployment (basic need) | 0.42 | 0.42 |
| Orphans | 0.05 | 0.05 |

| Germany, % of GDP | 2028 | 2060 |
|---|---|---|
| Hardship (housing, special needs) | 0.65 | 0.65 |
| **Strong net, total** | **9.63** | **10.98** |
| Transformation dividend | 7.25 | 3.40 |
| of which financed by steering taxes | 3.14 | 0.67 |

netz33.json (decision path). Quantities (pensioners, disabled, unemployed) and the reduction of the benefit catalogue are assumptions.

The common fund takes over public debt and pension claims above the dividend (on average 9.42 % of GDP in 2028). At a fund interest rate of 2.45 % – the euro-area average of 2006–2025 – it requires 5.17 % of GDP a year, financed by a surcharge of 15.5 % on all taxes. Its debt peaks at 148.1 % of GDP in 2055 and is repaid in 2098. Netting by state means that states with larger legacies carry a higher surcharge until 2058 (Table 5).

**Table 5: Contribution and surcharge by state after netting**

| State | Contribution 2028 (% GDP) | Surcharge 2028 (%) |
|---|---|---|
| Germany | 5.00 | 15.0 |
| France | 7.12 | 21.3 |
| Italy | 7.44 | 22.3 |
| Spain | 6.14 | 18.3 |
| Poland | 4.50 | 13.5 |

After netting in the common fund; converging to the common rate (15.5 %) by 2058.

## 4.4 VAT label and price level

The additional VAT burden is moderately progressive: relative to the mean it ranges from 0.87 in the lowest to 1.07 in the highest German income class, because rent, health, education and insurance are exempt (Table 6). The one-off price-level effect in 2028 is 2.47 % mechanically and 1.2 to 2.1 % with partial pass-through on taxable consumption only. VAT increases are passed on more strongly than cuts (Benzarti et al. 2020), so the upper end of the band is more likely; an asymmetric variant is not yet computed.

**Table 6: VAT label burden by income**

| Germany: household net income per month | Factor |
|---|---|
| <1000 € | 0.87 |
| 1000-1300 € | 0.91 |
| 1300-1500 € | 0.92 |
| 1500-2000 € | 0.96 |
| 2000-2600 € | 1.00 |
| 2600-3600 € | 1.01 |
| 3600-5000 € | 1.03 |
| ≥ 5000 € | 1.07 |

EVS 2023. Factor: additional VAT burden relative to the mean, as share of consumption.

| France: income quintile | Factor |
|---|---|
| Q1 | 0.90 |
| Q2 | 0.91 |
| Q3 | 1.00 |
| Q4 | 1.06 |

| France: income quintile | Factor |
|---|---|
| Q5 | 1.12 |

Eurostat HBS 2020 (hbs_str_t223, values flagged as estimated).

### 4.5 Marginal burden

Comparing new taxes with today's taxes alone would overstate the gain, because health, care and pensions are financed by contributions today and by taxes in the new system. Table 7 therefore adjusts today's burden for the part of the pension contribution that buys an own entitlement. At € 60,000 the burden on an additional euro falls from 48.8 % today to 40.0 % in 2028.

**Table 7: Marginal burden, Germany, single**

| Gross wage | Today | Today, adjusted (0.5 / 1) | New 2028 | New incl. compulsory saving |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 20,000 € | 35.8 | 31.1 / 26.5 | 32.0 | 40.5 |
| 42,000 € | 43.8 | 39.1 / 34.5 | 40.3 | 48.9 |
| 60,000 € | 48.8 | 44.1 / 39.5 | 40.0 | 48.5 |
| 100,000 € | 53.1 | 48.5 / 43.8 | 39.1 | 49.1 |
| 250,000 € | 44.3 | 44.3 / 44.3 | 40.0 | 50.0 |

Germany, single, % per additional euro of gross wage. Adjusted: the part of the pension contribution that creates an own entitlement is treated as saving (equivalence 0.5 or 1, assumption). Employer side and means-tested benefits not included.

## 5 Sensitivity

**Pass-through of employer contributions.** This is the most important single assumption. Evidence from Sweden shows that employers did not pass a cut in payroll taxes for young workers into their wages individually (Saez, Schoefer and Seim 2019); the proposal therefore makes pass-through a legal obligation with a fallback rule. Without any pass-through, the German single at € 42,000 still gains +258 €, but in France only 38 % and in Spain 53 % of single employees would be better off (Table 8).

**Table 8: Pass-through of employer contributions**

| Pass-through | DE single € 42,000 | Better off DE | Better off FR | Better off IT | Better off ES | Better off PL |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 % | +258 € | 84 % | 38 % | 98 % | 53 % | 98 % |
| 50 % | +479 € | 84 % | 71 % | 100 % | 98 % | 100 % |
| 80 % | +611 € | 98 % | 73 % | 100 % | 98 % | 100 % |
| 100 % | +699 € | 100 % | 73 % | 100 % | 100 % | 100 % |

Share of the employer contributions that disappear which is passed into gross wages; the remainder stays with the employer. Better off: single employees. 80 % is the adopted value (legal obligation with fallback rule).

**Fund interest and growth.** At a fixed rate of 3.5 %, close to German federal bond yields in October 2026, the surcharge rises to 18.7 % and the German single at € 42,000 gains +570 € instead of +611 € (Table 9). Sustainability depends on the gap between interest and growth: with low nominal growth and a contribution fixed at the adopted value, debt would not be repaid by 2098 (Table 10). Holding the pension claims Z constant in per cent of GDP across growth paths is a simplification.

**Table 9: Fund interest rate**

| Fund interest | Contribution (% GDP) | Surcharge (%) | DE single, € 42,000 |
|---|---|---|---|
| fixed 2.45 % | 5.17 | 15.5 | +611 € |
| fixed 3.0 % | 5.74 | 17.1 | +590 € |

| Fund interest | Contribution (% GDP) | Surcharge (%) | DE single, € 42,000 |
|---|---|---|---|
| fixed 3.5 % | 6.27 | 18.7 | +570 € |
| fixed 4.0 % | 6.82 | 20.4 | +548 € |
| transition 2.22 → 3.5 % | 6.20 | 18.5 | +572 € |
| transition 2.22 → 4.0 % | 6.70 | 20.0 | +553 € |

Nominal growth 3.0 %. Market yields October 2026 (secondary sources): German federal bonds 3.46 %, EU bonds 3.95 %.

**Table 10: Interest and nominal growth**

| Interest | Nominal growth | Contribution (% GDP) | Surcharge (%) | Debt 2098 at fixed contribution (% GDP) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2.45 % | 2.0 % | 6.22 | 18.6 | 87.4 |
| 3.00 % | 2.0 % | 6.83 | 20.4 | 168.8 |
| 3.50 % | 2.0 % | 7.40 | 22.1 | 274.3 |
| 4.00 % | 2.0 % | 7.98 | 23.9 | 421.1 |
| 2.45 % | 2.5 % | 5.68 | 17.0 | 35.9 |
| 3.00 % | 2.5 % | 6.27 | 18.8 | 93.3 |
| 3.50 % | 2.5 % | 6.83 | 20.4 | 168.0 |
| 4.00 % | 2.5 % | 7.40 | 22.1 | 272.5 |
| 2.45 % | 3.0 % | 5.17 | 15.5 | 0.1 |
| 3.00 % | 3.0 % | 5.74 | 17.1 | 40.2 |
| 3.50 % | 3.0 % | 6.27 | 18.7 | 92.9 |
| 4.00 % | 3.0 % | 6.82 | 20.4 | 167.1 |

Contribution and surcharge needed for repayment by 2098; last column: remaining debt (ten states) if the contribution stays at the adopted value.

**Avoidance at the top.** Revenue from inheritance (1.16 % of GDP) and large wealth (0.97 % of GDP after avoidance) depends on behaviour at the top of the distribution, where responses are strong (Jakobsen et al. 2020; Kleven et al. 2014). Across the avoidance band the German dividend changes by −55 to +25 € per adult and month in 2028.

**Take-up.** The model assumes complete take-up of the floor. Today, non-take-up of minimum income is high in Germany and France (DREES 2022; Eurofound 2015); a payment without application and a pre-filled top-up are designed to reduce it, which raises costs that are already fully counted.

## 6 Behavioural effects not in the model

A qualitative review of the literature (available in German in the research kit) assessed the expected responses to each building block:

- **Dividend:** experimental and quasi-experimental evidence finds small reductions in hours and little reduction in employment (Jones and Marinescu 2022; Vivalt et al. 2024; STM 2020).
- **Payment without application:** lowers non-take-up (Bhargava and Manoli 2015; Eurofound 2015); costs are already fully counted.
- **Compulsory saving with a default fund:** raises saving of passive savers, with partial crowd-out among active savers (Madrian and Shea 2001; Chetty et al. 2014).
- **Individual taxation:** raises hours of second earners (Bick and Fuchs-Schündeln 2018).

- **VAT label:** cuts reach consumers less than increases (Benzarti et al. 2020); consumers respond more strongly to taxes that are visible at the point of purchase (Chetty, Looney and Kroft 2009), which may strengthen the steering effect of a label (not tested).
- **Carbon price with rebate:** rebates are underestimated and do not reliably raise support (Douenne and Fabre 2022; Mildenberger et al. 2022).
- **Pension rule E:** loss aversion and resistance in the largest group of voters are an acceptance risk not captured by the model.

None of these findings questions the calculation as such; several show that outcomes depend on design details that are not yet fixed. A quantitative stage is open.

## 7 Limitations and open questions

- The model is static; behavioural responses are discussed but not quantified.
- Country models are simplified: one earner per household; regional rules and housing benefits beyond those named are not modelled; several parameters rest on secondary sources.
- The share of employees better off uses the German wage distribution scaled to each country's average wage; national wage distributions and two-earner couples are open.
- VAT burdens by income are available only for Germany and France.
- The tax base of company profits taxed where customers are has not been checked against an independent source.
- The common fund of 30 states is scaled from ten states; interest and growth are assumptions with a wide band.
- Compatibility with EU law and national constitutions has not been assessed.
- Which states could adopt common rules is open. Broad acceptance and reliable enforcement are preconditions; the World Justice Project's Rule of Law Index (2025) is one possible criterion. States outside Europe are not calculated.

## 8 Reviews, corrections and access

The calculation chain was recalculated in three reviews in October 2026, commissioned by the initiative. The second and third reviews re-implemented the core in their own code and confirmed it at rounding level; their findings and the responses are documented. The last review covered model version v4.42; the changes since then (up to v4.60) are listed on the website and have not yet been reviewed. A review of these changes is planned. Independent review is invited.

The log records every version with date, change, data source, moved figure and how it was noticed; 83 corrections have been numbered so far. The research kit with all figures to cite, the result files and the review documents is archived at doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23855733. Scripts, parameters and the full log are available to reviewers on request.

## References


1. Benzarti, Y., Carloni, D., Harju, J., Kosonen, T. (2020): What Goes Up May Not Come Down: Asymmetric Incidence of Value-Added Taxes. Journal of Political Economy 128(12).
2. Bhargava, S., Manoli, D. (2015): Psychological Frictions and the Incomplete Take-Up of Social Benefits. American Economic Review 105(11).
3. Bick, A., Fuchs-Schündeln, N. (2018): Taxation and Labour Supply of Married Couples across Countries. Review of Economic Studies 85(3).

4. Chetty, R., Friedman, J., Leth-Petersen, S., Nielsen, T., Olsen, T. (2014): Active vs. Passive Decisions and Crowd-Out in Retirement Savings Accounts. Quarterly Journal of Economics 129(3).
5. Chetty, R., Looney, A., Kroft, K. (2009): Salience and Taxation: Theory and Evidence. American Economic Review 99(4).
6. DREES (2022): Mesurer régulièrement le non-recours au RSA et à la prime d'activité. Les Dossiers de la DREES 92.
7. Douenne, T., Fabre, A. (2022): Yellow Vests, Pessimistic Beliefs, and Carbon Tax Aversion. American Economic Journal: Economic Policy 14(1).
8. Eurofound (2015): Access to social benefits: Reducing non-take-up. Luxembourg: Publications Office of the European Union.
9. Eurostat: datasets gov_10a_exp, gov_10a_taxag, gov_10dd_edpt1, nama_10_gdp, nasa_10_pens1, demo_pjanind, une_rt_a, prc_ppp_ind (retrieved 17 October 2026); ilc_di12, ilc_di01 (EU-SILC 2025, retrieved 18 October 2026); hbs_str_t223 (Household Budget Survey 2020, retrieved 24 October 2026).
10. Jakobsen, K., Jakobsen, K., Kleven, H., Zucman, G. (2020): Wealth Taxation and Wealth Accumulation: Theory and Evidence from Denmark. Quarterly Journal of Economics 135(1).
11. Jones, D., Marinescu, I. (2022): The Labor Market Impacts of Universal and Permanent Cash Transfers: Evidence from the Alaska Permanent Fund. American Economic Journal: Economic Policy 14(2).
12. Kleven, H., Landais, C., Saez, E., Schultz, E. (2014): Migration and Wage Effects of Taxing Top Earners. Quarterly Journal of Economics 129(1).
13. Madrian, B., Shea, D. (2001): The Power of Suggestion: Inertia in 401(k) Participation and Savings Behavior. Quarterly Journal of Economics 116(4).
14. Mildenberger, M., Lachapelle, E., Harrison, K., Stadelmann-Steffen, I. (2022): Limited impacts of carbon tax rebate programmes on public support for carbon pricing. Nature Climate Change 12(2).
15. OECD (2025): Taxing Wages 2025. Paris: OECD Publishing. – OECD (2026): Taxing Wages 2026. Paris: OECD Publishing.
16. Saez, E., Schoefer, B., Seim, D. (2019): Payroll Taxes, Firm Behavior, and Rent Sharing: Evidence from a Young Workers' Tax Cut in Sweden. American Economic Review 109(5).
17. Statistisches Bundesamt (Destatis): Einkommens- und Verbrauchsstichprobe (EVS) 2023, Konsumausgaben privater Haushalte.
18. STM – Ministry of Social Affairs and Health, Finland (2020): Results of Finland's basic income experiment.
19. Vivalt, E., Rhodes, E., Bartik, A., Broockman, D., Miller, S. (2024): The Employment Effects of a Guaranteed Income: Experimental Evidence from Two U.S. States. NBER Working Paper 32719.
20. World Justice Project (2025): Rule of Law Index 2025. Washington, DC.

## Appendix: Figures to cite

| No. | Item | Value | Unit | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Z01 | Transformation dividend per adult (Germany) | **354** | € per month | adopted |
| Z02 | Transformation dividend per child (Germany) | **283** | € per month | adopted |
| Z03 | Gain, single, gross wage € 42,000 (Germany) | **611** | € per month | adopted |
| Z04 | Gain, couple with one earner and 2 children, € 42,000 (Germany) | **674** | € per month | adopted |
| Z05 | Working-age households better off (Germany) | **85.1** | % | check |
| Z06 | All households better off (Germany) | **69.3** | % | check |
| Z07 | Pensioner households better off (pension rule E) | **32.2** | % | adopted |
| Z08 | Pensioner households, mean change (pension rule E) | **−121** | € per month | adopted |
| Z09 | Contribution to the common fund of 30 states | **5.17** | % of GDP | adopted |
| Z10 | Legacy surcharge on all taxes (common rate) | **15.5** | % | adopted |
| Z11 | Debt ratio of the fund, peak | **148.1** | % of GDP | adopted |
| Z12 | Fund fully repaid | **2098** | year | adopted |
| Z13 | Old pension claims above the dividend (Z) | **9.42** | % of GDP | adopted |
| Z14 | Total burden, taxes and fund (Germany) | **38.7** | % of GDP | adopted |
| Z15 | Total burden including compulsory saving (own account) | **42.8** | % of GDP | adopted |
| Z16 | Cost of the strong net (Germany) | **9.63** | % of GDP | adopted |
| Z17 | Marginal burden at € 60,000: today / new 2028 (Germany) | **48.8 / 40.0** | % per additional euro | check |
| Z18 | VAT label burden, factor lowest / highest income class (Germany) | **0.87 / 1.07** | relative to mean | adopted |
| Z19 | One-off price level effect of the VAT label 2028 | **1.2 to 2.1** | % | check |
| Z20 | Gain, single employee at the average wage (Germany) | **726** | € per month | adopted |
| Z21 | Gain, single employee at the average wage (France) | **276** | € per month | adopted |
| Z22 | Gain, single employee at the average wage (Italy) | **412** | € per month | adopted |
| Z23 | Gain, single employee at the average wage (Spain) | **321** | € per month | adopted |
| Z24 | Gain, single employee at the average wage (Poland) | **1,404** | zł per month | adopted |
| Z25 | Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (Germany) | **15** | % | adopted |
| Z26 | Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (France) | **21.3** | % | adopted |
| Z27 | Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (Italy) | **22.3** | % | adopted |
| Z28 | Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (Spain) | **18.3** | % | adopted |
| Z29 | Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (Poland) | **13.5** | % | adopted |
| Z30 | Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (Germany) | **30.1 → 26.1** | index 0–100 | check |
| Z31 | Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (France) | **30.4 → 29.0** | index 0–100 | check |
| Z32 | Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (Italy) | **31.0 → 26.9** | index 0–100 | check |
| Z33 | Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (Spain) | **30.8 → 25.0** | index 0–100 | check |
| Z34 | Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (Poland) | **24.9 → 18.7** | index 0–100 | check |

Source file and path of each figure: figures-to-cite.csv in the research kit (DOI 10.5281/zenodo.23855733). adopted: under the decisions of the initiative; check: cross-check or sensitivity.